



## Bose Intra-Ear Headphones

### The Comfortable Way To Aural Bliss!

In-ear headphones have always been the choice for those on the move. Two reasons—they're small, and they're small! Where they lose out is comfort. It's just not comfortable to have something stuck in your ear canal, no matter how soft they are... here's where Bose's Intra-Ear Headphones score. They've designed these earphones to mimic the contours of the ear canal.

The plugs consist of the actual sound unit, to which

silicone is attached. This silicone tapers to a thin, twisted, tube-like structure that exactly fits your ear canal, and delivers sound as close to your eardrum as possible. The plugs block out external sound rather effectively—good passive noise cancellation.

While the build quality is exemplary Bose, we'd have liked a black cable—the white/black audio cable just doesn't feel right.

A few minutes of Bose's test tracks saw them ditched

in favour of some of our favourite tunes. In a word, these earphones rock! There's good tone isolation, and the vocals are spot on. A few sessions of Whitney Houston and Sade among others convinced us that these were not only producing the highs and mids (including vocals) well, but they were pretty good with low frequencies too.

There's a very clear edge to the sound—no muting of frequencies whatsoever. Audiophiles will be satisfied with both fidelity and frequency reproduction. U2's *With or Without You* sounded great, good clean bass...

however, if big, booming bass is what you want, these aren't for you. We suggest Creative's EP630, which has bone-crunching bass but whose high-range frequencies are somewhat muddy.

At Rs 5,000, the Bose Intra-Ear Headphones aren't for everybody. It's for those who want a really good sound experience sans disturbance, while sacrificing zero on the comfort front.



#### RATINGS

|                 |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ★★★★★ |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★★ |
| Comfort         | ★★★★★ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★★ |
| Overall         | ★★★★★ |

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Price: Rs 5,000

## Microsoft LifeCam NX-6000

### Just A Compact Laptop Webcam

The LifeCam NX-6000 is a compact 2MP webcam with an inbuilt microphone, made for laptops, and it will easily fit into your pocket. The cam lens can be rotated vertically and also pushed into the body of the device when not in use. The LifeCam comes with a carry pouch.

The camera attaches to the laptop using a clip-on-like mechanism. A little indicator with "Microsoft" on it flashes when the camera is in use. Although not hot enough to cause any real damage, it still does get pretty warm. Pressing the sole button on the camera starts Windows Live Messenger.

Like all USB devices these days, installation is very simple. Plug it in and Windows XP (Service Pack 2) detects the camera and the microphone without your having to install any drivers.

A Vista-styled software called LifeCam is provided. It lets you record photos, audio, and movies. Visual effects can be added as well to make things a little more fun. Panning and zooming can be done, but only at lower

480 and 800 x 600 as expected from most webcams, but still image clarity is pretty good (but can be a little blurry at higher

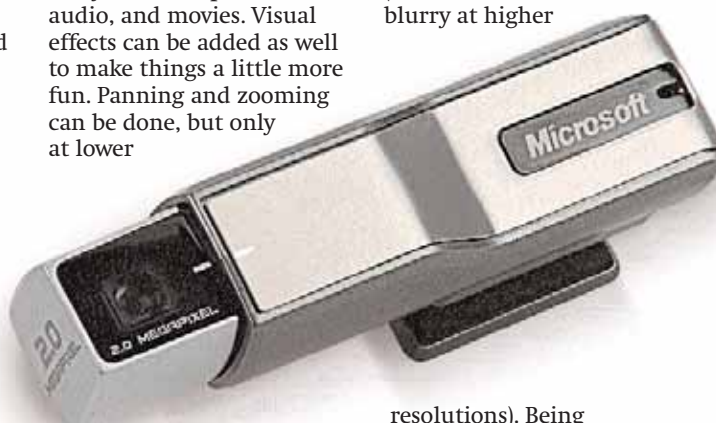
Video resolution ranges from 160 x 120 all the way up to 2MP—1600 x 1190. Video recording performance drops considerably the moment the resolution crosses 800 x 600. Recorded audio quality is all right, but the mic picks up ambient noise easily.

The Microsoft LifeCam NX-6000 retails at Rs 5,730—costlier than most desktop webcams, but for its small form factor and good image and video quality, it's worth the money for anyone who demands quality in videoconferencing while on the field.

resolutions). Being interpolated, the 7.6 MP image quality is quite poor.

The software lacks face-tracking features.

The LifeCam software can send images and clips through e-mail or upload it to Windows Live Spaces at the click of a button. Video is a little grainy at lower resolutions such as 640 x



#### RATINGS

|                 |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ★★★★★ |
| Features        | ★★★★★ |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★★ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★★ |
| Overall         | ★★★★★ |

#### Specifications

2MP; 3x digital zoom; inbuilt microphone; Vista Certified

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Price: Rs 5,730